



sp
Department of State

TELEGRAM

E-223

25

LIMITED OFFICIAL USE 360

PAGE 0: CAPE T 02025 311855Z

53
ACTION SCI 05

INFO AF 10, GPM 04, DODE 00, NASA 04, P 04, USIA 12, INR 07, CIAE 00, NSA 00

OST 01, NSC 10, RSR 01, RSC 01, /061 W

080541

R 311425Z OCT 68
FM AMCONSUL CAPE TOWN
TO SECSTATE WASHDC 1249
INFO AMEMBASSY PRETORIA
AMCONSUL JOHANNESBURG
AMCONSUL DURBAN UNN

LIMITED OFFICIAL USE CAPE TOWN 2025

1. DIVERS FOR LOCAL SALVAGE COMPANY HAVE FOUND DOME-SHAPED OBJECT ON FLOOR OF GRANGER BAY ONE-HALF MILE FROM SHORE ON ATLANTIC SIDE OF CAPE TOWN. CAPE ARGUS IN OCTOBER 30 EDITION SPECULATED "CONA-SHAPED OBJECT" IS "POSSIBLY TIP OF EXPERIMENTAL ROCKET." FRONT-PAGE ITEM REPORTED THAT "BEFORE US PUT MEN INTO SPACE, IT HAD ATLANTIC ROCKET RANGE DOWN WHICH IT FIRED EXPERIMENTAL MISSILES SOME OF WHICH WERE TRACKED TO WITHIN 500 MILES NORTH OF CAPE TOWN." ARTICLE SAID OBJECT, WHICH WAS FOUND NOSE DOWN ON SEABED, APPEARED TO HAVE BEEN SCORCHED UNDER TREMENDOUS HEAT.

2. OBJECT HAS BEEN IN CUSTODY OF CAPE DIVING AND SALVAGE COMPANY AT WHOSE OFFICE IT WAS INSPECTED BY MEMBER OF ALUSNA STAFF. HE DESCRIBES IS AS RESEMBLING SONAR BOOM, MEASURING ABOUT THREE AND ONE-HALF FEET IN DIAMETER, ONE FOOT IN DEPTH AND WEIGHING ABOUT FIFTY POUNDS. INSPECTION OF FRAGMENT SUGGESTS TO LAYMAN'S EYE THAT, BECAUSE OF APPEARANCE AND IRREGULARITY OF INTERIOR AND EXTERIOR SURFACES, METAL HAS BEEN SUBJECTED TO EXTREME HEAT. METAL IS ONE-HALF INCH THICK, APPEARS TO BE A LIGHT ALLOY, PERHAPS ALUMINUM, AND SHOWS NO SIGN OF CORROSION. HARDENED VEGETATION ON INTERIOR SURFACE INDICATES IT MAY HAVE BEEN ON BOTTOM FOR SOME TIME. THERE ARE NO IDENTIFICATION MARKS OF ANY KIND ON OBJECT.

3. UNLESS THERE IS ADDITIONAL PUBLICITY WITH SPECULATION AS TO IT BEING CONNECTED WITH US DO NOT RPT NOT PROPOSE TO CONSIDER

LIMITED OFFICIAL USE

REVIEWED BY C-6K Date 11/21/90
FOI, EO or PA exemption
TS authority to:
() CLASSIFY as OADR
() DOWNGRADE TS to () S or () C, OADR
DEPARTMENT OF STATE A/CDC/MR
() RELEASE
() EXCISE
() DENY
() DECLASSIFY in PART
() DELETE
() Non-responsive info.



Department of State

TELEGRAM
25

LIMITED OFFICIAL USE

PAGE 02 CAPE T 02025 311855Z

MAKING ANY COMMENT TO PRESS.

4. POUCHING FRAGMENT TO HERMAN POLLACK OF SCI AND WILL APPRECIATE
INFORMATION AS TO WHAT USE METAL MAY ORIGINALLY HAVE BEEN PUT.

EXEMPT MEAGHER

LIMITED OFFICIAL USE